

GA-HR-04

Staff Dress Code

Professional, practical, and safe dress for active learning, care, meetings, and school events.

APPLIES TO

Gardner Academy employees and relevant staff

AUTHORITY

Labour Act 11 of 2007 sections 5 and 41; Gardner Academy safety and professional standards

01 Purpose

Staff appearance should support safety, movement, dignity, and confidence in the school. Clothing must suit the professional role and the work being performed.

02 Everyday school dress

Choose comfortable professional clothing that allows you to sit on the floor, paint, build, garden, investigate, run, and play safely with students. Flat, secure, closed-toe shoes are expected for active duties unless management approves an alternative for a specific role or need.

03 Required standard

Clothing and appearance must:

- Be clean, neat, practical, and appropriate to the employee's role.
- Allow safe movement and active supervision.
- Provide suitable coverage while bending, reaching, sitting, or moving.
- Avoid offensive or discriminatory slogans, active campaigning, or prominent partisan messages that are inconsistent with a neutral, child-centred learning environment.
- Avoid loose accessories, footwear, or garments that create a safety risk.
- Respect cultural, religious, and personal expression while meeting genuine safety and inherent job requirements.

04 Formal occasions

For formal parent meetings, presentations, ceremonies, and designated events, staff may be asked to wear more formal professional clothing. Expectations will be communicated in advance where possible.

05 Questions and adjustments

A staff member who needs a dress adjustment for health, disability, pregnancy, religion, culture, or another protected reason should request it privately before departing from the required standard. Until an adjustment is approved, the employee should follow the existing dress requirement as far as safely and reasonably possible.